

Laser Hair Removal (De|Rive) — Service Knowledge Document

What It Is

Laser hair removal is a medical-grade treatment that uses concentrated light energy to permanently reduce unwanted hair. The De|Rive laser system targets hair follicles with precision, damaging them to slow regrowth and eventually eliminate hair in treated areas. It's a safe, effective, long-term solution to unwanted hair.

How it works:

- Laser light is absorbed by melanin (pigment) in hair follicles
- Light energy converts to heat, damaging the follicle
- Damaged follicles can't produce new hair
- Hair falls out over 1-2 weeks post-treatment
- Multiple sessions needed to catch all hair growth cycles
- Results in permanent hair reduction (80-90% reduction typical)

What it treats:

- Unwanted facial hair (upper lip, chin, sideburns)
- Body hair (underarms, bikini line, legs, arms, back, chest)
- Ingrown hairs and razor bumps
- Thick, coarse, dark hair (most responsive)

Key benefits:

- Long-lasting to permanent results
- Smoother skin without irritation
- No more shaving, waxing, or plucking
- Treats large areas efficiently
- Reduces ingrown hairs
- Cost-effective long-term vs. waxing
- Precision targeting

Treatment Areas & Pricing

Small Areas — \$100-\$150 per session

Examples:

- Upper lip
- Chin
- Sideburns
- Underarms (may be considered medium at some practices)
- Between eyebrows
- Hairline touch-ups
- Individual small zones

Best for: Quick touch-ups, facial hair, targeted areas

Medium Areas — \$200-\$250 per session**Examples:**

- Underarms
- Bikini line (standard bikini)
- Brazilian (full bikini)
- Lower face (chin + upper lip combined)
- Hands or feet
- Neck (front or back)
- Lower abdomen (happy trail)

Best for: Common problem areas, moderate hair coverage

Large Areas — \$300-\$350 per session**Examples:**

- Full legs (upper + lower)
- Half legs (just lower or just upper)
- Full back
- Full chest
- Full arms
- Shoulders

Best for: Extensive coverage, major hair reduction goals

Can combine multiple areas — ask about package pricing for treating several zones

Who It's For

Ideal candidates:

- Adults with unwanted hair
- People tired of constant shaving or waxing
- Those with dark hair (best results)
- Anyone seeking long-term hair reduction
- People with ingrown hair problems
- Those wanting smoother skin without daily maintenance

Works best on:

- Dark, coarse hair
- Fair to medium skin tones with dark hair (highest contrast)
- All skin tones (with appropriate laser settings)

Hair/skin combinations:

- **Best results:** Dark hair on light skin (maximum contrast)
- **Good results:** Dark hair on medium skin
- **Moderate results:** Dark hair on dark skin (requires specific laser)
- **Poor results:** Light, blonde, red, or gray hair (lacks melanin to absorb energy)

Perfect for treating:

- Facial hair (women with hormonal hair growth)
- Bikini area and Brazilian
- Underarms
- Legs and arms
- Back and chest (men)
- Any area with unwanted hair growth

Who Should NOT Get It

Avoid laser hair removal if you have:

- Very light, blonde, red, or gray hair (won't respond well)
- Active skin infections or open wounds
- Recent sun exposure or active tan (increases burn risk)
- History of keloid scarring in treatment area
- Uncontrolled diabetes (affects healing)

Postpone treatment if you:

- Recently waxed or plucked (need hair in follicle) — wait 4-6 weeks
- Have sunburn or recent sun exposure
- Are taking photosensitizing medications
- Recently used self-tanner (wait 2 weeks)

- Have active acne or skin irritation in area

Medical considerations:

- Pregnancy/breastfeeding: Generally postponed as precaution
- Polycystic ovary syndrome (PCOS): Can still treat but may need more sessions
- Accutane: Wait 6 months after stopping
- Blood thinners: May increase bruising
- Herpes simplex: May trigger outbreak (take preventive medication)

Medications to discuss:

- Accutane (isotretinoin)
- Photosensitizing antibiotics
- Retinoids
- Blood thinners

Typical Session Length

Varies by treatment area:**Small areas:** 10-20 minutes

- Quick, convenient appointments
- Perfect for lunch breaks

Medium areas: 20-40 minutes

- Moderate time commitment
- Comfortable session length

Large areas: 45-90 minutes

- Comprehensive treatment
- Plan for extended appointment

Process includes:

- Consultation and assessment (first visit)
- Shaving treatment area if needed
- Cooling gel application
- Laser treatment
- Post-treatment cooling and care

Typical Downtime

ZERO downtime!

Immediately after:

- Redness similar to mild sunburn (lasts 1-4 hours)
- Possible slight swelling around follicles
- Treated area may feel warm
- Looks like you just shaved (no visible hair)

Days 1-3:

- Any redness resolved
- Skin may feel slightly sensitive
- Treated hair still in follicles (will shed soon)

Days 7-14:

- Hair begins shedding ("peppering" out)
- Gentle exfoliation helps release hair
- Skin becomes progressively smoother
- Hair-free period begins!

Weeks 3-6:

- Smooth, hair-free skin
- New growth from dormant follicles may appear
- Ready for next treatment

Return to normal activities: Immediately **Return to exercise:** 24 hours (avoid excessive sweating immediately after) **Makeup/deodorant:** Can apply after treatment area cools

Results timeline:

- **After each session:** Progressive hair reduction
- **Full series (6-8 sessions):** 80-90% permanent reduction
- **Maintenance:** 1-2 sessions per year if needed

What Results People Often Notice

After 1st treatment:

- Smoother skin
- Hair grows back slower and finer
- Reduced irritation from shaving
- 10-25% hair reduction

After 3-4 treatments:

- Significant hair reduction (50-70%)
- Much less frequent shaving needed
- Patches of permanent hair loss
- Smoother texture overall

After 6-8 treatments (full series):

- 80-90% permanent hair reduction
- Drastically reduced need to shave
- Virtually hair-free in most areas
- Occasional fine hair may regrow
- Ingrown hairs eliminated
- Smooth, maintenance-free skin

Long-term:

- Results typically permanent
- Some people need 1-2 maintenance sessions yearly
- Hormonal changes can trigger new growth (rare)
- Overall dramatic improvement maintained

What it does NOT do:

- Remove 100% of hair permanently (some fine regrowth possible)
- Work on blonde, red, or gray hair
- Treat hair in one session (growth cycles require multiple visits)
- Prevent new follicles from activating (hormonal)

Aftercare Basics

First 24 hours:

- Avoid hot showers, saunas, hot tubs, steam rooms
- No excessive sweating or intense exercise
- Apply aloe or cooling gel if skin feels warm
- No sun exposure
- No deodorant for 24 hours (if underarms treated)
- Avoid tight clothing on treated areas

First week:

- Wear SPF 30+ on treated areas if exposed to sun
- Avoid tanning beds completely

- No waxing, plucking, or threading (shaving is OK)
- Gentle exfoliation after 5-7 days to help hair shed
- Use fragrance-free products on sensitive areas

Between sessions:

- **Shave only** — DO NOT wax, pluck, or thread
- Waxing removes hair follicles needed for laser targeting
- Exfoliate gently to release shedding hair
- Moisturize treated areas
- Continue sun protection

To maximize results:

- Complete full series of 6-8 treatments
- Space treatments 4-8 weeks apart (varies by area and hair cycle)
- Shave before each appointment
- Avoid sun exposure and tanning
- Follow all aftercare instructions
- Be patient and consistent

When to call us:

- Blistering or burns
- Severe pain or discomfort
- Signs of infection
- Unexpected skin reactions
- Excessive or prolonged swelling

Pricing Structure

Per Session Pricing:

- **Small Areas:** \$100-\$150 per session
- **Medium Areas:** \$200-\$250 per session
- **Large Areas:** \$300-\$350 per session

Recommended treatment plan:

- **Typical series:** 6-8 sessions for optimal results
- **Session spacing:** 4-8 weeks apart (depends on area and hair growth)
- **Maintenance:** 1-2 sessions yearly (if needed)

Example total costs for full series:

- Upper lip (6 sessions): \$600-\$900
- Underarms (6 sessions): \$1,200-\$1,500
- Brazilian (8 sessions): \$1,600-\$2,000
- Full legs (8 sessions): \$2,400-\$2,800

Package deals often available:

- Pre-purchase series at discounted rate
- Multi-area combination packages
- Seasonal promotions
- Ask about current specials!

Compare to lifetime of waxing:

- Monthly bikini wax (\$50-80): \$3,600-\$5,760 over 6 years
- Laser series for bikini: \$1,600-2,000 one-time
- **Laser = significant long-term savings!**

FAQs

Is laser hair removal permanent? It provides permanent REDUCTION, not always 100% permanent REMOVAL. Most people see 80-90% permanent hair loss. Fine, light regrowth may occur but is minimal and easily managed. Some may need occasional maintenance sessions.

Does it hurt? Most describe it as a quick snap or rubber band flick. We use cooling technology to minimize discomfort. Pain level varies by area—bikini and underarms are more sensitive than legs. Most people tolerate it very well.

How many sessions will I need? Typically 6-8 sessions spaced 4-8 weeks apart. Hair grows in cycles; laser only affects actively growing hair. Multiple sessions catch all growth phases. Exact number varies by area, hair thickness, and individual factors.

Why do I need multiple sessions? Hair grows in three phases: anagen (growing), catagen (transitional), and telogen (resting). Laser only works on actively growing hair (anagen). At any time, only 20-30% of your hair is in this phase, so multiple treatments are needed to catch all follicles.

Can I shave between treatments? YES! You should shave. Just DON'T wax, pluck, thread, or use depilatory creams—these remove the follicle that the laser needs to target.

What if I have blonde or gray hair? Unfortunately, laser hair removal doesn't work well on light, blonde, red, or gray hair because they lack enough melanin to absorb the laser energy. It works best on dark hair.

Is it safe for all skin tones? Yes! Modern lasers can be adjusted for different skin tones. Darker skin requires specialized settings to avoid burns. We customize treatment for your specific skin type.

When will I see results? You'll notice slower regrowth after the first session, but dramatic reduction becomes visible after 3-4 treatments. Full results appear after completing the 6-8 session series.

What happens to the hair after treatment? Hair doesn't fall out immediately. Over 7-14 days, treated hair sheds (exfoliates out). During this time, it may look like hair is growing, but it's actually dead hair being pushed out.

Can I tan during treatments? No! Avoid sun exposure and tanning beds throughout your treatment series. Tanned skin increases burn risk and makes treatment less effective. Always wear SPF.

How far apart are sessions? Spacing depends on the area:

- Face: Every 4-6 weeks
- Underarms/bikini: Every 6-8 weeks
- Legs/back: Every 8-10 weeks This aligns with hair growth cycles for each area.

Will insurance cover this? Laser hair removal is typically cosmetic and not covered by insurance, except in rare cases of medical necessity (e.g., severe pseudofolliculitis barbae). Check with your provider.

Next Steps

Ready to say goodbye to unwanted hair?

1. **Book your FREE consultation:** Online at harmonyaestheticsandwellness.glossgenius.com or call/text (240) 280-0020
2. **During your consultation:**
 - We'll assess your hair and skin type
 - Determine if you're a good candidate
 - Recommend treatment plan and session count
 - Explain process and realistic expectations
 - Provide exact pricing for your specific areas
 - Answer all your questions
3. **Choose your treatment areas:**
 - Small (\$100-150): Upper lip, chin, etc.
 - Medium (\$200-250): Underarms, bikini, etc.

- Large (\$300-350): Legs, back, chest, etc.
- 4. **Avoid waxing/plucking** starting 4-6 weeks before first appointment
- 5. **Shave treatment area** 24 hours before each session
- 6. **Commit to the series** (6-8 sessions) for best results

Questions? Text us at (240) 280-0020 or use the contact form on our website.

Perfect for: Long-term hair reduction, smooth skin, eliminating ingrown hairs, saving time and money on shaving/waxing

Remember: Laser works best on dark hair. Light, blonde, red, or gray hair won't respond well.

Disclaimer: This information is for educational purposes only and does not replace a consultation with our providers. Individual results vary based on hair color, skin type, and other factors. Consultation required to determine candidacy and create treatment plan.